Mental Health
FIRST AID

from NATIONAL COUNCIL FOR
MENTAL WELLBEING

Instructor Policy Handbook

2025

Dear Instructor,

Thank you for being a Mental Health First Aid (MHFA) Instructor! Our Instructors are the heart of this vital program. Your commitment will help countless people gain the knowledge and tools to identify, understand and respond to those experiencing a mental health or substance use challenge.

Please review the policies in this handbook thoroughly to ensure your compliance with the program.

The National Council for Mental Wellbeing values your unique talents and abilities! Before you teach your first session, I encourage you to reflect on your own passion for mental wellbeing. As an Instructor, you play such an important role in the lives of those experiencing mental health and substance use challenges, largely because you teach others how to offer help. As you lean into that role, I believe you will become a more enthusiastic, effective Instructor.

Thank you for your dedication to mental wellbeing and substance use awareness. I wish you the best of luck on your journey as a MHFA Instructor!

Sincerely,

Deanna Roepke
Chief Program Officer
National Council for Mental Wellbeing

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I. Using the Instructor Policy Handbook

A. Purpose

This handbook provides all Mental Health First Aid (MHFA) USA Instructors the most up-to-date Instructor policies and procedures. Every Instructor must review this document in its entirety before delivering courses. Coordinators should also be familiar with these policies to fully support the Instructors for whom they coordinate.

B. Adhering to Policies

Upon certification to teach any MHFA course type, regardless of delivery method, Instructors must agree to adhere to all policies and procedures outlined in this Instructor Policy Handbook.

C. Communicating Policy Updates

MHFA USA reserves the right to update or add policies to this handbook at any time. Instructors will be notified of changes through official MHFA emails or newsletters and/or on MHFA Connect.

D. Enforcement

MHFA USA takes Instructor policies seriously and reserves the right to investigate policy violations and false representations. Failure to adhere to any policy will be handled on a case-by-case basis. Gross misconduct and policy violations could result in suspension or revocation of Instructor certification.

II. Instructor Certification Status

A. Certified

“Certified” status indicates an Instructor may deliver MHFA courses with or without a co-Instructor. Instructor candidates must receive a passing score by their National Trainer on the Instructor Teach-back Rubric portion of their Instructor Training to be certified. The anniversary date for certified Instructors is the final day of their first Instructor training.

B. Provisionally Certified

Adult and Youth Instructor Candidates who receive “Provisionally Certified” status on the Instructor Teach-back Rubric during their Instructor Training and must complete additional requirements to attain full certification. (See Item C under Instructor Annual Certification Requirements.) Provisionally Certified Instructors may not teach, even with a Certified co-Instructor, until they have completed all provisional requirements and become fully certified.

Instructor Candidates who receive a provisional score during their teach-back will be notified of their provisional status by their National Trainer. The National Trainer will also provide the Instructor with additional information and resources for becoming a fully certified Instructor.

teen Mental Health First Aid (tMHFA): There is no provisional status for tMHFA Instructors. Instructors must receive a passing score by their National Trainer on their teach-back rubric to be certified. Instructors who do not receive a passing score are offered an opportunity to re-do their teach-back for a passing score.

C. Quality Evaluation Provisional

Instructors with "Quality Evaluation Provisional" status have received post-evaluation scores below 4.0 on a scale of 1 to 5. MHFA USA will work with the individual Instructor to develop a customized improvement plan to return them to Certified status. MHFA USA staff will provide additional information and resources to any Instructor placed on Quality Evaluation Provisional status.

D. Decertified

An Instructor who does not meet annual certification requirements will be decertified and prohibited from teaching any MHFA courses in any capacity. A decertified Instructor can pursue reinstatement by successfully completing a new 3-day Instructor certification course. The decertified Instructor must apply, be accepted and pay any related fees. They will be subject to the same standards as a new Instructor.

E. Suspended

MHFA USA will suspend an Instructor, when necessary, to investigate misconduct or a policy violation. During a suspension, the Instructor is prohibited from teaching any MHFA courses. MHFA USA will issue a determination of status within 30 days of the suspension.

F. Revoked

When certification is revoked, the Instructor loses all MHFA certifications. They are no longer permitted to teach MHFA courses and must cease claiming any affiliation with MHFA USA as an Instructor. Any Instructor whose certification is revoked is ineligible for reinstatement.

III. Instructor Annual Certification Requirements

Newly Certified Instructors should allow up to 40 hours post-certification to become familiar with the content of the entire course.

A. Annual Single Certification Requirement

Adult and Youth MHFA

Unless otherwise noted by the National Council, Instructors must teach AND document a minimum of three courses, taught to fidelity, per anniversary year and complete all curriculum updates by their anniversary date.

Note: Community-specific MHFA courses can be used to fulfill the annual teaching requirement.

tMHFA

Certified tMHFA Instructors are required to teach a minimum of one course per anniversary year. Please note, only two Instructors can receive credit for a single course.

B. Annual Dual Certification Requirement

Adult and Youth MHFA

Instructors must teach AND document a minimum of three courses per anniversary year.

tMHFA

The tMHFA annual certification requirement of teaching one tMHFA course per year is separate from the annual certification requirements for Adult and Youth MHFA. Dual or triple certified Instructors (i.e., those that are certified as tMHFA Instructors and Adult or Youth MHFA Instructors) must teach one tMHFA course and teach their three courses per year for their Adult and Youth MHFA certification to maintain all their certifications.

C. Provisional Certification Requirements

Please note, there is no provisional status for tMHFA Instructors.

Instructors with provisional status in Adult or Youth MHFA may not teach, even with a Certified co-Instructor, until they have completed all provisional requirements and become fully certified.

To become fully certified, provisional Instructors must complete the following requirements:

1. **Within 30 days of your MHFA Instructor training:**
    a. Complete your Post-work for your MHFA Instructor Training in MHFA Connect.
    b. Complete the **Instructor Candidate Training Provisional Post-Work** course in MHFA Connect.
        i. You will receive an enrollment email from MHFA Connect with 72 hours of your Instructor training.

ii. Locate and select the course on your MHFA Connect dashboard, under "Enrolled Courses."
iii. Complete the e-learning component of the course.

2. **Within 60 days of your MHFA training:**
   a. Complete your provisional Instructor teach-back.
      i. Select link in Assignment. Schedule 1:1 teach-back session with MHFA staff via Calendly. You will present the same segment you taught during your initial teach-back.
      ii. Enter "I have scheduled the teach-back" in the text box and select Submit Assignment. Then click Yes to confirm assignment submission.
3. **Stay Compliant**
   a. MHFA Instructors are required to teach at least three courses each year (based on the anniversary of your Instructor training) to maintain certification.
   b. Any course you teach or co-teach counts toward the yearly minimum. While you must only co-facilitate one course to satisfy your provisional Instructor requirements, you may continue to schedule and co-facilitate classes throughout the provisional period.

If you have additional questions about the provisionally certified status, email Provisional@TheNationalCouncil.org.

D. Instructor Responsibility for Maintaining Certification

The MHFA Instructor certification is owned by the individual Instructor and is not property of any organization that might have sponsored the Instructor's certification. The Instructor is independently responsible for meeting all certification requirements.

E. Extensions

Instructors who have not successfully completed their recertification requirement by their anniversary date may request a 3-month extension, a request that MHFA USA may or may not grant. To be considered, requests must be submitted at least 30 days prior to the anniversary date using the Extension Request Form found on MHFA Connect.

If the request is accepted, the Instructor's anniversary will updated to the date they successfully complete the recertification requirements.

If an Instructor does not meet the extension requirements, they will be decertified and must complete the reinstatement process to teach MHFA. MHFA USA reserves the right to deny extension requests.

IV. Instructor Quality Evaluation Process

To help Instructors reach their full potential and teach the best course possible, MHFA USA will regularly review the post-evaluation scores of courses. After reviewing low post-evaluation scores (below 4.0), MHFA may place an Instructor on "Quality Evaluation Provisional" status.

MHFA USA will work with an individual Instructor to develop a customized improvement plan. The additional resources that may be part of the process include, but are not limited, to a combination of any of the following:

- Participating in a one-on-one coaching call with a MHFA staff member.
- Participating in a group coaching call.
- Co-facilitating a training with a seasoned Instructor.
- Watching Instructional Training Videos on MHFA Connect.
- Completing a reflection activity related to an area of improvement.

V. Dual Certification and MHFA Community-specific Course Considerations

Instructors may carry certifications in more than one MHFA curriculum. Specific assumptions apply as stated below:

For Dual Adult/Youth Certification

- Instructors are required to teach one course in their first curriculum before becoming certified in the second.

To Become Certified to Teach in Another Language

- At this time, MHFA Adult and Youth courses can be taught in English or Spanish. Instructors may obtain a dual certification for language but should teach in the first language they've been certified in before earning a certification in another language. For example, if an Instructor is initially certified to teach in English, they should teach a course in English before applying for certification in MHFA for Spanish-speaking Communities.

For MHFA Community-Specific Courses

- MHFA recommends teaching two MHFA courses (Youth or Adult, as appropriate) before applying to teach a MHFA Community-Specific course.

Adult and Youth MHFA Community-Specific Courses are packages of resources that reframe the standard 7.5-hour In-person course for Adult MHFA Instructors to be more relevant to a specific audience.

Instructors must have knowledge and experience with the target audience as specified in each Community-specific course. We also recommend Instructors teach two courses in their foundation curriculum (e.g., Adult MHFA) prior to obtaining any supplemental course

certifications. Community-specific courses only apply to the specified MHFA curriculum and are not to be incorporated with another MHFA curriculum. Available Community-specific courses include (as of February 2025):

- Adult MHFA for Higher Education
- Adult MHFA for Fire and EMS
- Adult MHFA for Law Enforcement, Corrections and Public Safety
- Adult MHFA for Veterans, Service Members, and their Families
- Adult MHFA for Older Adults
- Adult MHFA for Rural Communities
- Adult MHFA for Spanish-speaking Communities
- Adult MHFA for Korean-speaking Communities
- Adult MHFA for Khmer-speaking Communities
- Adult MHFA for Chinese-speaking Communities
- Youth MHFA for Chinese-speaking Communities
- Youth MHFA for Tribal Communities and Indigenous Peoples
- Youth MHFA for Spanish-speaking Communities
- Youth MHFA for Korean-speaking Communities
- Youth MHFA for Khmer-speaking Communities

VI. Becoming Certified in teen MHFA as an Adult or Youth Instructor

Any school, youth-serving organization or organization in partnership with a school that wants to bring tMHFA training to their teens can apply to become a tMHFA Site. Interested schools and organizations must be accepted as a tMHFA site before they teach tMHFA.

If you are interested in bringing tMHFA to teens in your community, visit the MHFA website to complete the tMHFA Interest Form. A member of the MHFA team will reach out to schedule a call with you to discuss the program and begin your application.

The MHFA team member will ask if you are able to meet a set of tMHFA implementation requirements (see the tMHFA webpage). Interested schools and organizations will need to sign a contract to show their commitment to teaching the program with fidelity and adhering to the implementation requirements.

VII. Instructor Profile

Instructors are required to actively maintain their Instructor profiles. Please notify the National Council via the Request Assistance Form if you need to change your email address. The National Council communicates important programmatic information via email, so it is critical that Instructors ensure their email address is accurate. All other information can easily be updated through MHFA Connect.

VIII. Delivering Mental Health First Aid USA Courses

A. Required Safety Protocols

Adult and Youth MHFA

All Instructors are required to implement the following safety protocols in every course taught:

- Collect emergency contact information for each participant.
- The co-Instructor/virtual course support person will monitor the virtual hallway and periodically private chat with each learners to check how they are feeling.
- Follow up with learners who leave the virtual Instructor-led portion of the class without alerting the Instructor, co-Instructor or virtual course support person.
- Provide the following national crisis resources, and any local mental health resources, to all participants:
    - 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline
        - Call or text 988.
        - Military and Veterans press 1.
        - Spanish-speakers press 2.

Disseminate and collect MHFA Exit Tickets from learners at the end of each virtual Instructor-led training. Learners should be instructed to stay in the session until they have submitted their MHFA Exit Ticket. Instructors should review the MHFA Exit Tickets immediately after the course concludes. Instructors should reach out to any learner who has indicated they want to be checked on by phone or email. Instructors should have a plan to connect a learner to local emergency mental health services or national crisis resources if the learner indicates they are in significant distress following the course.

tMHFA

It is the responsibility of the tMHFA Site to put the following safety mechanisms in place and abide by them:

1. Responding to teens during the tMHFA courses or program implementation:
    - A teen who shows signs of distress during the course or who is not responding or participating.
    - A teen who causes the tMHFA Instructors alarm or concern about their safety (physical or mental).
    - Teens who ask for assistance for themselves or a friend during the course.
2. Administering and responding to Exit Tickets.
    - Sites must collect Exit Tickets from teens at the end of each Instructor-led session. Teens will not be allowed to leave the Instructor-led session until they have submitted their Exit Ticket.
    - Instructors, in accordance with their site protocol, may choose to administer physical or digital Exit Tickets. They must have a plan to respond in a timely manner to teens who ask for assistance for themselves or a friend during the course.
3. Have a mental health professional available while the tMHFA Instructor-led session is being taught, should a teen need to be contacted and/or requests additional support.
    - This could be a school mental health professional, a community mental health professional or another adult identified by the site who can assist the tMHFA Instructor.
    - Direct contact information for the mental health professional or a site staff person must be readily available to teens and tMHFA instructors. This ensures a teen can reach out for support if they need to speak to an adult during or after the training.
4. Provide information about tMHFA to parents/guardians.
    - This information must include the safety protocols, instructions for opting their child out of the course and a tMHFA site contact to whom parents/guardians can reach out while their child takes the course.
5. Provide information about tMHFA to teens prior to taking the course.
    - This information must include the safety protocols and whom to contact with questions or concerns about taking tMHFA.
6. Maintain current and accurate contact information for a parent/guardian and/or an emergency contact for every teen who is taking the course.
    - Instructors must have the emergency contact information available to them while they are teaching the Instructor-led session in the event they have urgent concerns about a teen's safety.
7. Two adults must always participate in the Instructor-led session.
    - One must be a certified tMHFA Instructor. The other adult may be a classroom teacher, mental health professional or another trusted adult familiar with the

training that is certified in YMHFA.

B. Instructor Professionalism and Conduct

Instructors are ambassadors of the Mental Health First Aid program and must always maintain professional conduct. Instructor professionalism and conduct is defined as:

- Establish and sustain a safe and nonjudgmental learning environment for learners.
- Openly respect alternate viewpoints.
- Lead with empathy and compassion.

C. Spirit

Mental health and substance use can often be viewed as somber, serious or "heavy" topics. MHFA courses give appropriate weight to the severity of certain mental health and substance use challenges while also emphasizing hope for recovery and presenting the material in a relaxed and comfortable environment. Reducing the stigma associated with mental wellness challenges is a primary goal of the course and should touch every aspect of the course.

D. Course Instruction

MHFA courses may be facilitated by one or two certified Instructors. No more than two Instructors are permitted to teach any MHFA course. Non-certified Instructors may not teach the course.

E. Course Size and Format

Adult and Youth MHFA

Instructors should present to groups of a size they are comfortable managing that also has enough learners to foster group discussion. The minimum course size is five learners, and the maximum course size for all course delivery options (Blended and In-person) is 30 learners.

Instructors may include in their annual Instructor recertification renewal ONE course in which five or more learners were enrolled, but fewer than five attended. The remaining two classes required for Instructor recertification must have five or more learners in attendance.

tMHFA

MHFA USA recommends that In-person tMHFA course sizes stay within the range of five to 30 teens.

Instructors may include in their annual Instructor recertification renewal ONE course in which five or more learners were enrolled, but fewer than five attended. The remaining two classes required for Instructor recertification must have five or more learners in attendance. However, assembly-style sessions are strictly prohibited, because the course is intended to be discussion-based. Instructors are encouraged to stay within the standard classroom sizes of the school or organization.

For Blended tMHFA courses, MHFA USA recommends a minimum of five teens and maximum of 30 teens in a virtual Instructor-led session to ensure that Instructors can monitor and support teens effectively in the virtual environment.

F. Use of Instructor Materials

Instructors are required to use the most current course materials and may not use or distribute out-of-date materials. When materials are revised, Instructors will have ample time to review and acquire the updated materials. Regardless of certification status, Instructors may not reproduce any documents, handbooks, books, information or other materials provided in full or in part without express written permission from MHFA USA. This extends to any materials provided during Instructor training courses.

The only course document that may be printed without express written permission is the Participant Processing Guide. Only the learner assigned this document may print this document.

G. Registering Courses via MHFA Connect vs. Submitting data via MHFA Connect Submit-a-Course

Instructors are required to register all courses they deliver in MHFA Connect or submit course data via MHFA Connect Submit-a-Course, regardless of whether it is open to the public. An Instructor must register the class or submit course data to receive credit toward their annual recertification requirement. **Only courses registered in MHFA Connect or submitted via the MHFA Connect Submit-a-Course will count toward annual certification requirements.** Course data for courses taught via Submit-a-Course should be submitted within 30 days of the course date.

All tMHFA courses, including In-person and Blended courses, must be managed through the Submit-a-Course process and course data should be submitted within 30 days of the course date.

MHFA USA encourages Instructors to register their courses as soon as they are scheduled, ideally at least two weeks prior to the delivery date, to allow ample time for learners to complete any preparation or required pre-work (if applicable). Registering courses within five days of the course may diminish the learner's experience. Late access to any preparation or pre-work (if applicable for the course delivery type) could limit the Instructor's ability to establish and maintain fidelity to the content.

Ensure that course registration and course submission entries contain accurate, specific and complete information. For example, include the specific start and end times as well as the exact location. If you are delivering a specific Adult MHFA Community-specific course, make sure it is accurately listed.

When managing course delivery through MHFA Connect, Instructors must add courses before they take place, and they must ensure learners complete all required course assignments. Only learners who are enrolled in the course prior to when the course takes place and complete all

required course assignments will be eligible for a First Aider certificate. Instructors may not mark attendees complete in any course or course module they have not completed in full.

H. Scheduling Courses

Adult and Youth MHFA

- In-Person Courses
  - Instructors scheduling a course must allow for the designated number of hours for instruction, plus breaks and lunch. Courses scheduled over multiple days must not occur more than two weeks apart. Please see the timing guide in your teaching notes for in-person course scheduling suggestions.
- Blended Courses
  - Instructors scheduling a course must allow the designated number of hours for the Instructor-led training portion of their Blended course, and they should also include time for breaks or lunch.
    - Blended Adult MHFA with In-person Instructor-led training (ILT) – Courses include approximately two hours of pre-work and 5.5 hours ILT content; allow an additional 30 minutes for breaks.
    - Blended Adult MHFA with Virtual ILT – Courses include approximately two hours of pre-work and 5.5 hours ILT content; allow one additional hour for breaks.
    - Blended Youth MHFA with In-person ILT – Courses include approximately two hours of pre-work and 4.5 hours ILT content; allow an additional 30 minutes for breaks.
    - Blended Youth MHFA with Virtual ILT – Courses include approximately two hours of pre-work and 4.5 hours ILT content; allow one additional hour for breaks.
    - Blended courses with in-person or virtual ILT can be scheduled for a maximum of two separate sessions.
  - To reschedule an Instructor-led session in MHFA Connect, change the date and time of the Instructor-led session module within the course.

tMHFA

In-person tMHFA

Please see the timing guide in your teaching notes for in-person course scheduling suggestions.

Completion of the course is defined as attendance in all Instructor-led sessions, therefore, only teens who attend all Instructor-led sessions will receive a certificate. Learners who are unable to attend all lessons may receive a certificate of participation.

For this reason, scheduling make-up sessions for teens that are absent is strongly encouraged. Schedule make-up sessions outside of MHFA Connect, coordinating dates and times directly with the teens who need to attend. Refrain from recording the teen's attendance in the session that was missed in MHFA Connect until they've attended a make-up session.

Blended tMHFA

Blended tMHFA is currently only available in Version 1.0. The sole Blended learning option for tMHFA consists of six sessions. Within each session, teens participate in:

- tMHFA Self-paced work: Instructors help teens in Blended classes access these sessions. Each self-paced work directs teens to reference additional content in the tMHFA manual and prepares them for the corresponding Instructor-led session with the base knowledge to support the discussion and activities. Lessons introduce teens to foundational content including an overview of the tMHFA Action Plan and key definitions such as mental health and mental health challenge.
- tMHFA Instructor-led Sessions: Instructors facilitate these sessions in person or via videoconference. Instructors use the tMHFA Blended Teaching Notes to guide the sessions, which build on the content teens learned in the corresponding self-paced work. Instructors can review the content, respond to questions and then facilitate discussions that make the information relevant to the teens. Instructors guide teens through activities that allow them to practice skills such as having a supportive conversation with a friend and using the tMHFA Action Plan. Instructors may use any videoconferencing platform of their choosing.
- Skill-Building Scenarios: Three animated skill-building scenarios help teens apply and practice their tMHFA skills. Teens "meet" virtual peers and use the tMHFA Action Plan to help them navigate difficult situations.

Completion of the course is defined as completion of all components of the course – including self-paced work, Instructor-led sessions and skills-building scenarios. Only teens who attend all Instructor-led sessions will receive a tMHFA certificate, so scheduling make-up sessions for teens who are absent is strongly encouraged. Schedule make-up sessions outside of MHFA Connect, coordinating directly with the teens that need to attend a session on dates and times. Refrain from recording the teen's attendance in the session that was missed in MHFA Connect until after they've attended a make-up session.

IX. Marketing Courses

A variety of marketing resources are available on the Resources page of MHFA Connect – you can select **Marketing** from the category dropdown menu to narrow your results. These items include customizable resources such as a press release template, one-pager templates, social media templates and a PowerPoint presentation to help you discuss your MHFA offerings with members of your community.

If you need to make additional support materials to promote your course, you must adhere to our brand guidelines, which, along with MHFA logos, are available on the resources page of MHFA Connect.

The MHFA Connect Storefront has merchandise such as banners, pens and stickers to help you market your course.

Please do not develop your own MHFA merchandise (such as, plush toys, bobble-head dolls, bumper stickers, T-shirts). If there is an item you feel our storefront is missing, please submit your suggestion via the **Request Assistance form**. To find the form, go to the **Resources** page under the Primary Navigation Menu of MHFA Connect, and select **Request Forms** from the category filter dropdown.

Short sections of a course, up to three minutes in length, may be videotaped, with permission of the Instructor(s) and learners, for marketing or journalistic purposes.

X. Pricing

Instructors are responsible for setting and collecting their own course fees and should make every effort to ensure prices are set to promote accessibility. Regardless of the actual price of the course, MHFA requires Instructors and Coordinators communicate that the course has a value of $170 per learner. When an Instructor offers a discounted or no-cost course, promotional materials must acknowledge that learner fees are being underwritten. An example of such language is: “This course is valued at $170. Thanks to a generous donation from ABC Organization, learners may attend at no charge.”

XI. Course Cancellations and Refunds

Adult and Youth MHFA

Learner Refunds:

Instructors may set their own policies for cancellations and refunds to learners. MHFA USA encourages Instructors to include cancellation and refund policies in course promotional materials, and suggests that Instructors require at least 48-hours (or two business days) notice for a cancellation by a learner in order to receive a refund. Cancellation information should include the mechanism for contacting learners (phone, email or text). If the Instructor institutes a refund policy for learners, they should indicate the conditions under which a refund would be issued, the amount of the refund and the length of time it would take to receive the refund. If there is no cancellation or refund policy, it should be clearly stated.

Instructor Refunds:

MHFA USA does not process refunds for any unused materials. For blended courses, Instructors will be invoiced based on the Instructor-led training roster, which must be submitted within 48 hours of course completion. If the roster is not submitted within 48 hours of course completion,

the Instructor will be invoiced for all registered participants listed on the course roster and will need to request any necessary refunds via the MHFA Request Assistance Form.

tMHFA

tMHFA Sites are responsible for purchasing tMHFA manuals for each teen they plan to teach prior to the course. Regardless of whether the course is in-person or blended, every teen must receive a printed manual. tMHFA Sites should ensure they have enough manuals for each teen taking the course. MHFA USA does not process refunds for any tMHFA manuals.

XII. Unenrolling Learners From a Blended Course

Adult, Youth and teen MHFA

Learners taking Blended courses are assigned self-paced work as part of their required course assignments. If a learner is unenrolled from a course, any amount of coursework they have completed up to that point will be lost. If the learner chooses to enroll in a future course, the Instructor can submit an MHFA Request Assistance Form to ask for the self-paced work portion of the learner's course assignment be marked as complete. Evaluations and examinations will need to be recompleted by the learner once enrolled in the future course. Please share this information with your learners as part of their course experience.

XIII. Instructor Age

Applicants must be 18 years of age to be considered for entry into an Instructor Training.

XIV. Use of the Mental Health First Aid Trademark.

The National Council has registered MENTAL HEALTH FIRST AID®, MHFA®, and Mental Health First Aid at Work® with the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office.

No entity other than the National Council, the Mental Health Association of Maryland or the Missouri Department of Mental Health may use these terms in any of the following ways, unless they have received express, prior, written consent from the National Council:

- Register a domain name containing either MENTAL HEALTH FIRST AID®, MHFA®, and Mental Health First Aid at Work®
- Form an entity with either MENTAL HEALTH FIRST AID®, MHFA®, and Mental Health First Aid at Work®
- Change an existing entity name to one containing either MENTAL HEALTH FIRST AID®, MHFA®, and Mental Health First Aid at Work®

Instructors, Coordinators and Organizations may use these trademarks to promote MHFA courses.

If you come across improper use of these trademarks, please share with the Mental Health First Aid team via Hello@MentalHealthFirstAid.org.

XV. Copyright for Materials

All MHFA course material is the copyright of MHFA International and cannot be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise, without the proper permission of the original copyright holder. “Course documents” also incorporates materials from the National Council for Mental Wellbeing. The added content is owned and copyrighted by the National Council and cannot be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, transmitted, or distributed in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, or otherwise, without the proper permission from the National Council. No part of any related publications may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means — electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise — without prior permission.

MHFA USA is managed, operated, and disseminated by the:

- National Council for Mental Wellbeing
- Missouri Department of Mental Health
- Mental Health Association of Maryland

XVI. Distribution of Course Materials

Adult and Youth MHFA

Instructors are required to distribute the following to each learner:

- Participant Manual
- Participant Processing Guide (Required for blended courses only.)
- Self-care Template
- Community Resource List
    - Instructors must create and provide an appropriate Community Resource List for each learner in a course.

tMHFA

- tMHFA Manual – a printed manual is required for all tMHFA courses, regardless of whether the course is in-person or blended. tMHFA Sites and Instructors are required to distribute the tMHFA manuals to teens.
  There is no participant processing guide for tMHFA.

The distribution -- in any format -- of any MHFA course PowerPoint Slide Deck, Teaching Notes and other instructional material is strictly prohibited.

XVII. Use of Course Materials Outside of Mental Health First Aid Courses

Instructors are not permitted to use MHFA course materials for any purpose other than delivering the MHFA course within the United States, its districts, territories, embassies and military bases.

XVIII. Presentation Requests

All decisions on presentation and speaking requests are made at the sole discretion of the Instructor. If you decide to accept a presentation or speaking engagement on a topic that relates in any way to Mental Health First Aid USA or the National Council for Mental Wellbeing, we have three guidelines for you to keep in mind:

- We ask that you share these engagements with us, for awareness purposes only. We may reach out to learn more about your implementation story for potential communication or media opportunities through the National Council.
- Should any media requests arise from your speaking engagement, we would appreciate the opportunity to be looped in and be involved as needed.
- Last, to avoid any confusion, we request that you communicate that you are not speaking on behalf of Mental Health First Aid USA or the National Council for Mental Wellbeing. We suggest the inclusion of the following language in your presentation:

The opinions expressed in this presentation are solely my own and do not reflect the beliefs or stances of Mental Health First Aid USA or the National Council for Mental Wellbeing. Any information provided here is based on my personal knowledge and understanding, and should not be construed as official statements from these organizations.

XIX. Language Considerations

A. Content Interpretation and Translation

1. Mental Health First Aid Adult and Youth courses may be offered in English, Spanish, Korean, Khmer and Chinese. teen MHFA courses may be taught in English and Spanish. An Instructor may teach the course in any of these languages, as long as they are fluent, and they have earned the corresponding Instructor designation.
2. Instructors may not translate the course into any other language. If an Instructor needs to translate a few key words to a learner to enhance their understanding, this is encouraged; however, they are not permitted to translate any of the course

information or materials. Please refer to the MHFA Instructor Guide to Fidelity for more guidance. Maintaining MHFA's curriculum fidelity and quality is of the utmost importance, and this cannot be guaranteed without a formal process of translation and localization.

XX. Accessibility

A. Accessibility of Facility

MHFA USA strives to make this training accessible to all. When choosing a location to hold courses, an Instructor should make every effort to find accessible spaces where public transportation is readily available. When conducting a virtual Instructor-led training, consider reviewing virtual engagement best practices. Please visit https://www.ada.gov/ada_title_III.htm for information about public space accessibility.

B. Accessibility of Curriculum

MHFA is dedicated to making its curricula accessible to all. MHFA has accessible versions of various portions of the curricula for Adult and Youth MHFA. Instructors who need to receive a copy should submit their request through the Request Assistance form on MHFA Connect.

C. Videotaping, Photography and AI Notetakers

Instructors are not permitted to allow videotaping of the course, photographing, screen recording or screen shots of the presentation slide deck. Instructors are also not permitted to allow the use of AI notetakers during the course. Short sections (up to three minutes) of a course may be videotaped for marketing or journalistic purposes, with permission of both the Instructor and learners. If a short section of the course is taped for any reason, MHFA USA suggests Instructors obtain signatures from all learners indicating they have agreed to be filmed.

D. Use of Video Platform When Teaching Virtual Instructor-led training

Do not post online meeting details (such as links or passcodes) in any public forum, as this could lead to uninvited participants joining a virtual Instructor-led training. Online meeting details originate in MHFA Connect.

XXI. Liability and Mental Health First Aid USA Courses

A. Legal Liability for Instructors

At this time, MHFA USA does not require Instructors to carry any liability insurance. Any questions about liability coverage for Instructors should be directed to an Instructor's legal advisor or insurance carrier.

B. Legal Liability for First Aiders

If First Aiders have questions about liability issues surrounding practicing MHFA USA, the following information may be communicated: First Aiders who have completed the program are by no means required to act on their knowledge – but have simply been provided with information on how they may be able to do so. Application of course information does not supersede organization policies regarding mandatory reporting.

Good Samaritan laws cover help provided by First Aiders in the communities. However, the details and extent of these laws vary by state.

XXII. Non-disparagement

Instructors shall not disparage MHFA (including its curriculum, policies and materials) or MHFA or National Council directors, managers, partners, employees, agents and affiliates. Nothing in this section shall prevent Instructors from truthfully and accurately responding to any question, inquiry, or request for information when required by law, regulation, court order, or any other valid legal process. This provision shall continue to bind instructor even if instructor's certification is revoked, or instructor is de-certified or suspended.

PLEASE NOTE – The Participant Manuals provide the following disclaimer:

"The information on this manual is for informational purposes only and is not intended as a substitute for medical professional help, advice, diagnosis or treatment. It is not intended to establish a standard of care for the provision of emergency mental health services. Always seek the advice of a qualified health care provider if you have concerns regarding a medical condition or treatment. Never disregard professional medical advice or delay in seeking it because of something you read in this manual. The information, including but not limited to, text, graphics, images and other material contained in this manual are for the purpose of promoting broad consumer understanding and knowledge on mental health care. None of the procedures provided in this manual represents or warrants that any particular procedure is safe, appropriate or effective for you or anyone whom you deem requires assistance of Mental Health First Aid. Reliance on any information appearing in this manual is solely at your own risk. If you are in the United States and experiencing a medical emergency, please call 911 or for emergency medical help on the nearest phone.:

Suicide & Crisis Lifeline – Call or text 988

This is a crisis hotline that can help with many issues, not just suicide. For example, anyone who feels sad, hopeless or suicidal; family and friends who are concerned about a loved one; or anyone interested in mental health treatment referrals can call the Lifeline. Callers are connected with a nearby professional who will talk with them about what they are feeling or their concerns for other family and friends. Call or text 24 hours/day, seven days/week.

Military and veterans press 1. For Spanish, press 2.